Year 7 Admission Assessment v3.1: assessor instructions

Version 3.1, October 2026. Use with `Y07/Y07_Student_Paper_v3.1`. Version 3.1 is version 2 with the third reading text (Part C) removed: the listening, writing, maths, science and interview are unchanged from version 2. The reading paper is now Parts A and B (16 marks) in the same time as before. Do not mix papers and instructions from different versions: the question numbers, marks and band guides differ.

Reusable: print once and keep in the assessor's folder. Do not write on these pages. Record each candidate's marks on their own **grading sheet** (`Y07_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`), reading on the **Reading front sheet** and the interview on the **Interview sheet**.

For students applying to join **Year 7** (age 11 to 12 on 1 September). A Year 7 entrant from a Chinese mainstream school has usually **completed Grade 5** and is the same age as a student starting Grade 6. The maths paper starts at the level expected for entry to Year 7 (the end of UK Year 6) and goes well beyond it, so several topics (dividing fractions, powers, negative numbers, percentages, expanding brackets, equations with the unknown on both sides, the nth term, vertically opposite angles) **may not have been taught yet**. Section 4 lists them. Background, the English bands and the decision guide are in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`.

1. At a glance

Order	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Materials	Notes
1	Welcome	2	Assessor	Student paper, pencil, rubber, ruler	Script in Section 2
2	Listening (paper pages 2 to 5): Part A, a phone message; Part B, a short talk	about 14 (recording)	Assessor plays the recording, or reads each script twice	These instructions, Section 3.1; the recording	Can be done with a small group
3	Reading paper (pages 6 to 9)	15	Student works alone; assessor times	Clock or timer	Do not read the texts aloud
4	Writing (pages 10 to 11)	10	Student works alone		Choose one of two tasks
5	Break	5		Water	
6	Maths (pages 12 to 17)	25	Student; assessor may read questions aloud	No calculator, no protractor	Section A fluency, Section B word questions, Section C applied problems
7	Science (pages 18 to 20)	8	Student; assessor may read questions aloud		
8	Interview, opening with sentence reading	15	Interviewer, 1:1	Interviewer guide, Interview sheet, Reading front sheet, Sentence reading guide and card, a plain card	Sentence reading starts at **Level 6** (sentence 16)
	Total	**about 94**			Plus the parent conversation (about 15 minutes, separate)

Marks go on the **grading sheet** (listening, writing, maths and science), the **Reading front sheet** (reading) and the **Interview sheet** (speaking).

For each candidate:

- the Year 7 v3.1 student paper (20 pages, A4);
- the grading sheet (`Y07/Y07_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`);
- the Reading front sheet (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`);
- the Interview sheet for Years 7 to 10 (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y7_Y10`);
- the parent conversation record (`forms/Parent_Conversation_Record`);
- the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`).

For the room (print once, laminate the cards):

- these instructions;
- the Interviewer guide (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y7_Y10`);
- `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`;
- the sentence reading card (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`; laminate it);
- the other equipment in the table above: a pencil, a rubber and a ruler for each candidate, a clock or timer, a plain card to cover the sentences, and water for the break.

2. Before you start

Welcome script. Say, in a calm, friendly voice:

> "Hello, I'm … . Welcome to our school. Today you will do some activities in English: listening, reading, writing, maths and science. Then we will have a chat. The activities help us get to know you and find the right support for you. Some questions are easy and some are hard. That is fine. Do your best, and it is OK if you cannot answer everything. In maths and science I can read a question to you. In the English parts I cannot explain words, because we want to see your English. You can always ask me to say an instruction again. Do you have any questions?"

Pace of speech. Many Year 7 students are still learning English: speak steadily and clearly, with a short pause after each sentence, when you give instructions, read the listening scripts and read maths and science questions aloud. Use the same pace for every candidate, so that the results can be compared. The listening recording is paced the same way.

Access rules (the same in every year group; details in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 7)

	English sections (listening, reading, writing, sentence reading)	**Maths and science**
Reading aloud	Read only what the script says. Do not explain words, translate or read the reading texts aloud. You may repeat instructions in English.	Read any question aloud in English, as often as asked, and point to the picture.
Chinese	Not used by staff.	If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the student cannot follow the English after it has been read aloud, the colleague may say the question **once** in Chinese. Mark the question **L** in the margin. The mark still counts.
Answers	**In English only.** An answer in Chinese scores 0.	**In English only.** Numbers, ticks, drawings and working count. An answer, reason or explanation written in Chinese scores 0, even after an L reading.
Not yet taught		If the student says they have not learnt a topic, write **NT** beside the question. It scores 0. List NT topics and L questions on the grading sheet.

- **Extra time or a reader** for a known need is allowed; record it on the grading sheet.
- **Stopping.** The student may stop any section when they have done what they can. Listening Part B is meant to stretch fluent students: a student who is new to English may follow little of it, and that is expected. In the reading paper, if the student is clearly stuck, let them stop and say "Thank you, that is fine." In maths, the paper goes well

beyond the expected level, so many students will not finish; reassure them. In writing, if the student cannot write in English, ask them to write any words they know, or a plan; do not score Chinese writing, but keep it. Never push a distressed student: take a break or stop, and record it on the grading sheet.

- **Keeping the student at ease.** Explain the order of the morning and the break. Sit beside, not opposite, for the interview. Praise effort, not answers ("Thank you, you are working hard"). Do not show surprise at mistakes. Keep the timer out of the student's line of sight, and give a calm two-minute warning near the end of each timed part.

3. English

3.1 Listening (about 14 minutes with the recording, 16 marks)

Two parts, each read twice. **Part A** is everyday listening: the version 1 task, unchanged (questions 1 to 8). **Part B** is academic listening: a short lesson at the level of a science lesson for a fluent student of 11 or 12 (questions 9 to 16). Read Part A, let the student finish, then go straight on to Part B. The recording takes about 14 minutes: both scripts twice, one minute to read each set of questions and the time to finish.

Recording. A recording of this test is in `audio/v3.1/Y07/` (see its `READ_ME_FIRST.txt` for the tracks and timings). Play it instead of reading the script: every candidate then hears the same voices, pace and pauses. The script below is its transcript, and the live reading option if no recording can be played. Read live at the recording's pace, one reading of Part A takes about 1 minute 36 seconds and of Part B about 2 minutes 28 seconds, with the pauses: use this to check your own pace. Do not pause the recording during a reading of the script. Play Part A and Part B as separate tracks if you may stop after Part A; otherwise the full track plays both.

Part A: a phone message (questions 1 to 8, 8 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Listening page. This is Part A. I am going to read a phone message. Li Na is calling her friend Sofia. I will read it two times. First, read the questions." Give the student **one minute** to look at questions 1 to 8 (pages 2 and 3). Then say: "Now listen. You can answer while I read."

Read it twice at the steady pace in Section 2. Pause for about 3 seconds at each [pause]. After the first reading, say "Now listen again" and read it again. After the second reading, give one minute to finish. Do not repeat any part of the message, and do not explain any word.

> **Script: a phone message**
>
> Hi Sofia, it's Li Na. I'm calling about our plan for Saturday. **[pause]**
>
> The cinema in Riverside Mall is closed this weekend, so we can't see the film. Let's go to the science museum instead. **[pause]**
>
> We can meet outside the main entrance at half past nine. **[pause]**
>
> The easiest way to get there is by metro. My dad is picking us up at four o'clock, so you don't need to take the metro home. **[pause]**
>
> Please bring your student card, because students get cheaper tickets. And bring a packed lunch. The café in the museum is really expensive, and we can eat in the garden. **[pause]**
>
> On the metro, take Line 2 and get off at Lakeside Station. Then use Exit 4. The museum is right in front of you. **[pause]**
>
> Tickets are usually 40 yuan, but students only pay 25 yuan. **[pause]**
>
> Please don't be late, because the first show in the space theatre starts at ten o'clock. **[pause]**
>
> My brother Jun went to the museum last week. He's fourteen, and he thinks everything is boring. But even he said the robot exhibition was amazing! It closes on Sunday, so this is our last chance to see it. **[pause]**
>
> Please send me a message tonight and tell me if you can come. Bye!

Answers. One mark each. Spelling does not matter if the meaning is clear. Answers must be in English.

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
1	**B** science museum		A (cinema): heard "cinema" but missed "closed". C: heard "Mall".
2	**B** 9:30		C (10:00): heard the time of the show, not the meeting time.
3	**B** metro		C (car): heard "My dad is picking us up", which is for going home.
4	**Both** student card **and** packed lunch		One correct only, or three or more ticked: 0. "Money for the café" is a distractor.
5	**4**	four	2 (the metro line).
6	**25**	25 yuan, ¥25	40 (the usual price): missed "but students only pay".
7	The first show (in the space theatre) starts at ten.	They will miss the show; the show is at 10; they must be there before the show.	"Because they meet at half past nine" with no reason.
8	To show that the robot exhibition must be very good: even her brother, who thinks everything is boring, liked it.	To make Sofia want to come; because the robots are amazing; because it is good and it closes soon.	"Because he is fourteen"; "because he is boring".

Part B: a short talk (questions 9 to 16, 8 marks)

Say: "Now turn to Part B, on page 4. You will hear a short talk. A science teacher is giving a lesson about deserts. I will read it two times. You have one minute to read questions 9 to 16." After **one minute**, say: "Now listen. You can answer while I read."

Read it twice at the steady pace in Section 2, as you would explain something to a class of fluent 11 year olds. Pause for 2 to 3 seconds at each [pause]. After the first reading, say "Now listen again" and read it again. After the second reading, give **one minute** to finish. Do not slow down to dictation speed, speed up, repeat any part, or explain any word: Part B measures whether the student can follow a lesson in English at this pace.

Script: a short lesson about deserts

Good morning, everyone. Today we are finding out how plants and animals survive in one of the harshest habitats on Earth: the desert. **[pause]**

When you hear the word "desert", you probably imagine golden sand and blazing sunshine. However, scientists define a desert by its precipitation, which means rain or snow, rather than by its temperature. A desert receives less than 250 millimetres of precipitation a year, while Shanghai, by comparison, gets more than a thousand. By this definition, about a third of the land on our planet is desert. The largest is the Sahara, in North Africa. Actually, I need to correct that: the Sahara is the largest hot desert, but the largest desert of all is Antarctica. **[pause]**

Even when rain does come, it usually falls in one short, heavy storm, and much of it evaporates, or turns into water vapour, within a few hours. So how does anything survive? The answer is adaptations: special features that help a living thing to survive in its habitat. **[pause]**

Take the cactus. Most plants lose a lot of water through their leaves. A cactus, on the other hand, has sharp spines instead of leaves, and as a result, far less water escapes into the air. Its thick stem stores water like a tank, while its roots spread out widely, just below the surface. **[pause]**

Many desert animals are nocturnal: they shelter from the heat of the day and look for food at night. The fennec fox has enormous ears, which release heat from its body, whereas the Arctic fox has small ears that keep heat in. Many people think a camel's hump is full of water. In fact, it is full of fat, which the camel can turn into energy when food is scarce. **[pause]**

The most remarkable example, though, is a beetle from the Namib Desert, in south-west Africa. On foggy mornings, it climbs to the top of a sand dune and leans forward into the wind. Tiny drops of water from the fog collect on its back and then roll down into its mouth. **[pause]**

So, next time someone tells you that a desert is an empty place, you might ask them how carefully they have looked.

What the talk contains (measured from the script above): 364 words in 23 sentences, an average of 16 words per sentence. 23% of its words are not among the 2000 most common English words in the `wordfreq` lists; with the method of `02_Listening_Evidence_Statement` (word endings matched, names of places not counted) the figure is about 19%, against 6 to 15% for the version 1 scripts. Features: a process (how the beetle collects water) and cause and effect (spines, so less water escapes); comparisons (a cactus and most plants; the fennec fox and the Arctic fox; desert and Shanghai rainfall); numbers (250 millimetres, more than a thousand, a third, a few hours); subject words explained in passing (precipitation, evaporates, adaptations, habitat, nocturnal); a self-correction ("Actually, I need to correct that"); a misconception corrected ("In fact"); an opinion that is implied, not stated (the last sentence); discourse markers (however, while, by comparison, on the other hand, as a result, whereas, in fact, though).

Answers. One mark each (questions 12 and 13 are one mark per gap). Spelling does not matter if the meaning is clear. Short answers and notes are fine: the writing is not marked here. Answers must be in English. The questions follow the order of the talk; question 16 is about the whole talk.

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
9	Specific detail (a number)	**250** (millimetres)	two hundred and fifty	1000 or "a thousand" (Shanghai's rainfall): heard the comparison, not the definition.
10	Specific detail (a name)	**Antarctica**		The Sahara: missed the self-correction ("Actually, I need to correct that: the Sahara is the largest hot desert"). The Namib: caught a later name only.

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
11	Inference joining two parts of the talk	Rain does not last long in a desert: it comes in one short storm and much of it evaporates within a few hours, so roots just below the surface can take in the water quickly, before it evaporates.	Any answer that links the roots to the rain disappearing quickly: "to catch the rain fast before it dries up"; "the water evaporates quickly, so the roots must get it quickly"; "the rain only comes for a short time".	"To get water" or "to drink water" with no link to the rain disappearing quickly (a literal answer that does not join the two parts); "to hold the cactus up"; "because it rains a lot".
12	Note completion	**heat**	body heat; heat from its body; the heat; hot air	"water", "sound"; "cold" (mixed up with the Arctic fox's small ears that keep heat in).
13	Note completion	**fat**	fats; fat for energy	"water": the belief the teacher corrects ("Many people think a camel's hump is full of water. In fact, it is full of fat"): heard the first sentence, missed "In fact". "Energy" alone: what the fat becomes, not what fills the hump.
14	Process: a sequence	From the top: **3, 1, 4, 2** (climbs the dune, leans into the wind, drops collect on its back, water rolls into its mouth)		Any other order: 0. All four must be right for the mark. "Leans" before "climbs" usually means the student caught the words but not the order.
15	Speaker's attitude (implied)	**They have not looked carefully enough.**		"They are right": took "an empty place" at face value and missed the meaning of "you might ask them how carefully they have looked".
16	Main idea	**how plants and animals survive with very little water**		"why deserts are always hot and sandy" (the talk says the opposite; caught "sand" and "sunshine" from the opening); "camels" (one detail).

Band guide v2 (listening, / 16). Use the part scores, in this order:

Result	Band
Part A 0 to 2	**A**
Part A 3 to 4	**B**
Part A 5 to 6, or Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 0 to 2	**C**
Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 3 to 5	**D**
Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 6 to 8	**E**

Use judgement when a result is uneven (for example Part A 6 with Part B 6, which can happen when a student misses one picture item but follows the talk well): look at which items were lost, and check against "listening in conversation" on the Interview sheet.

What to look for

- In Part A, questions 1 to 4 each have a distractor. A student who chooses the distractor every time is catching single words ("cinema", "ten", "dad") without the sentence around them: typical of band B. Questions 7 and 8 need inference.
- Part A shows secure everyday listening; Part B shows whether the student can follow a lesson at normal speed. A fluent Year 7 listener answers most of Part B quickly, including questions 11 and 15, which depend on joining ideas rather than catching words.

- Questions 10 and 13 have a strong distractor that is said first and then corrected ("Actually", "In fact"). A student who chooses the Sahara or writes "water" is following word by word and missing how the speaker's ideas connect: typical of band C or low D.
- A student who scores 7 or 8 in Part A but 0 to 2 in Part B copes with everyday English but will find lessons in English hard at first: band C, with listening support planned.
- **English barrier or something else?** If a student scores low but follows your spoken instructions easily, check whether the problem was speed (they may do better in conversation) or attention. Note it for the interview on the Reading front sheet.

3.2 Reading paper (15 minutes, 16 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Reading pages. Read the texts and answer the questions. There are two parts. Part B is harder than Part A. Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish. You have 15 minutes." Start the timer. Do not read the texts or questions aloud, and do not explain words. You may repeat this instruction. Give a two-minute warning.

Mark scheme. Spelling and grammar are not marked in reading answers if the meaning is clear. Answers copied from the text are fine when they answer the question. Answers must be in English; an answer in Chinese scores 0.

Part A: After-school clubs (a notice; very accessible, with pictures)

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
1	Tuesday	Tue	
2	Room 14	14	Library
3	5:30 pm	5:30, half past five, 17:30	4:15
4	Basketball		
5	a False · b True · c False		1 mark for each correct row (3 marks)
6	Drama	Drama Club	Art

Part B: Mist (fiction, age-appropriate for a fluent reader of 11; this was Part C in version 1, with the same questions and answers, renumbered)

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
7	Retrieval	Next to Tom	By the window; at the empty desk by the window	
8	Retrieval	A place they loved	A favourite place; a place they like	His grandfather's tea garden (what Chen Yu drew, not what was asked)
9	Inference	He was alone and did not want people to see it.	He had nobody to talk to; he was shy, nervous or lonely; he did not know anyone; so nobody would notice him	He was hungry; the rice was hot
10	Vocabulary in context	flow fast, like a river		
11	Inference with evidence (2)	**1 mark** for a feeling: nervous, shy, lonely, worried, scared, uncomfortable, sad, alone, not happy. **1 mark** for evidence that fits: he counted the faces; nobody looked up; he kept his eyes on the board; he copied every word; Tom did not say a word; he sat at the end of the table; he ate slowly to look busy.	Evidence in the student's own words	A positive feeling ("happy", "excited") scores 0 for the feeling; the evidence mark can still be given if the evidence is correct.

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
12	Why do you think	To make a joke; to make Chen Yu feel welcome or relaxed.	To show the club is friendly and you do not need to be good at sport; because Tom is bad at football too; to make him laugh	"Because they play football in the club"
13	Author's purpose	The grey streets show Chen Yu's feelings: he feels happier or more hopeful now, because he has made a friend.	He is not lonely now; his day got better; things seem better because of Tom and the art club	"Because the rain stopped" (not in the text: a literal reading; note it)

Band guide (version 3.1; use judgement when a result is uneven, and check against the sentence reading screen)

Result	Band
Part A 0 to 3	**A**
Part A 4 or more, Part B 0 to 2	**B**
Part B 3 to 5	**C**
Part B 6 to 8	**D** or **E** (see below)

D or E. Part B is the age-level text, so 6 or more shows at least a competent reader. Give **E** only when Part B is 7 or 8 **and** the sentence reading screen (meaning checks and fluency) and the writing also point to E. Version 3.1 has no text above age level, so the reading paper alone cannot confirm band E.

Record the reading paper marks (Part A, Part B), the band and the question where the student stopped at 15 minutes on the **Reading front sheet**, and give it to the interviewer.

What to look for

- Part B (Mist) is the age-level story: a fluent reader of 11 scores 6 or more.
- A student who does Part A well but leaves the end of Part B blank may have run out of time rather than understanding. Note where they stopped at 15 minutes on the Reading front sheet.
- **English barrier or reading difficulty?** Most students in this pack are learning English, so low scores usually reflect vocabulary. If a student reads aloud fluently in the sentence reading screen but scores low here, the gap is vocabulary and comprehension, not decoding. If a student is slow and inaccurate in both, and also reads slowly in Chinese (ask the parents), note a possible reading difficulty on the Reading front sheet.

3.3 Writing (10 minutes, 16 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Writing page. Choose one task and tick it. Plan in the box first. Then write. Try to write about 20 lines. You have 10 minutes." You may repeat the instruction. Do not explain the prompts.

The tasks

- **Task 1 (narrative):** a story that begins "When Mei opened the box, she could not believe her eyes."
- **Task 2 (opinion):** "The school summer holiday should be shorter." Do you agree?

Marking. Score each criterion 0 to 4 (1 and 3 are between the descriptions). Total / 16. Then give the band by **best fit** with the descriptors in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 6, using the total only as a check.

Criterion	0	2	4
Content and organisation	Nothing in English, or isolated words; no link to the task.	A short response that follows the task; ideas listed with simple links ("and", "then"); a beginning but a weak or missing ending; little paragraphing.	A complete, well-shaped story or argument for the age: an opening that sets the scene or position, ideas developed with detail or reasons and examples, a clear ending; paragraphs; the reader is kept in mind.

Criterion	0	2	4
Vocabulary	Single memorised words or copied words.	Everyday words used correctly; some repetition; gaps filled with simple words or Chinese.	A wide range for the age, chosen for effect (precise verbs and adjectives, some less common words); words for linking ideas ("however", "although", "for example").
Grammar and sentences	No sentences.	Simple sentences, some joined with "and", "but", "because"; frequent errors (verb tenses, plurals, articles, word order) but meaning is mostly clear.	Varied sentences, including complex ones ("When ...", "which ...", "if ..."); tenses controlled (past for the story, present for the opinion); errors are rare and do not affect meaning.
Spelling and punctuation	Spelling makes most words hard to read; no punctuation.	Common words spelt correctly; longer words phonetically plausible; full stops and capital letters used, not always correctly.	Accurate spelling, including most longer words; sentence punctuation secure; commas, question marks, apostrophes and speech marks mostly correct.

Rough guide to the total (best fit decides): 0 to 3 **A** · 4 to 7 **B** · 8 to 10 **C** · 11 to 13 **D** · 14 to 16 **E**.

Band E writing at Year 7. Comparable to a fluent writer of 11 or 12. In 10 minutes, usually 150 to 250 words in clear paragraphs. The story has a real event and an ending, with some dialogue or description; the opinion gives a clear view, two or three reasons with examples, and often mentions the other side. Sentences are varied and controlled, vocabulary is chosen with care, and errors are few and minor. Some fluent writers write less in 10 minutes but very well: judge quality, not just length.

What to look for

- Typical features of Chinese-speaking learners (missing past tense -ed or plural -s, "a" and "the", "he" and "she" mixed) are normal stages of learning English. Score them under grammar, but read past them to judge content.
- A student who writes a strong plan but few lines may think well but write slowly in English: note it in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet.
- Writing much weaker than speaking is common in students from oral-heavy English courses. Writing much stronger than speaking is common in students taught through grammar and textbook dialogues.

3.4 Speaking and sentence reading (the interview, 15 minutes)

The interview is 1:1. The questions and the speaking band descriptors are in the **Interviewer guide** (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y7_Y10`), and the record is the **Interview sheet** (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y7_Y10`). It opens with the **Graded Sentence Reading Screen**: the rules, your copy of the sentences and the meaning questions, and the reading age table are in `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`; the student reads from `shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`; the results go on the **Reading front sheet**. For Year 7, **start at Level 6 (sentence 16)**, and follow the rules in the guide for going back, stopping, the meaning checks and fluency. If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1. Then use the interview questions (school and learning, interests, friends and wellbeing, future plans and aspirations, values, an opinion question) and give the **speaking band** with the descriptors in the Interviewer guide, recording it on the Interview sheet.

Pace. Ask the questions at the pace in Section 2, the same for every candidate.

The Interviewer guide's opinion questions include homework and phones. These do not overlap with the writing tasks above.

4. Maths (25 minutes, 30 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Maths pages. There are three sections. Section A is calculation and algebra. Section B is word questions: read the question, write an equation and solve it. Section C is problems with pictures, tables and charts. You cannot use a calculator. Show your working in the boxes: you can get marks for your working. I can read any question to you. Just ask. You have 25 minutes."

Read any question aloud on request, as often as asked, and point to the picture. Follow the access rules (Section 2): mark **L** if a Chinese-speaking colleague gave a question once in Chinese, and **NT** if the student says they have not

learnt the topic. Answers, reasons and explanations must be in English (numbers and working count).

What the paper is for. Version 2 is aimed at the higher end. It starts at the level expected for entry to Year 7 (the end of UK Year 6) and goes well beyond it, into Year 7 and early Year 8 content; there are no easy "floor" questions. It measures three things separately, because students from Chinese schools are usually strong in the first and less practised in the other two: **fluency** (Section A: calculation and algebra with no context), **word questions** (Section B: problems given only in sentences, which the student must read and set up) and **applied problems** (Section C: multi-step problems in real or unfamiliar contexts, with diagrams, charts and "Show" or "Explain").

Marking. Accept any clear, correct method. A correct answer scores full marks, with or without working, except where the question says **Show** or **Explain** (questions 14 and 18c) or asks for reasons (16): there the working or reason is part of the answer. In Section B, a correct answer scores 2 however it was found (an equation, a bar model, or trial and improvement with a check). Accept equivalent answers (for example 6/10 for 3/5) unless the question says otherwise. Units are printed on the paper, so a missing unit does not lose a mark. **M1** is a method mark: give it for a correct method with one arithmetic slip, or for the step named, when the final answer is wrong.

Section A: Fluency (10 marks)

Q	Answer	Marks	Accept, partial credit and common errors	Content
1	a 4 7/12 · b 3/5	1 + 1	a: 55/12, 3 19/12. 3 8/10 means the student added the numerators and the denominators. b: 0.6, 24/40, 6/10. 64/15 or 4 4/15 means the student multiplied instead of dividing.	Adding mixed numbers with different denominators (the expected level for entry); dividing mixed numbers
2	80	1	8 or 800: a place value slip.	Dividing by a decimal
3	100	1	316 means $(3 \times 6)^2$; 5.5 means the student worked from left to right ((108 – 64) ÷ 8).	Order of operations with powers and brackets
4	19	1	–1 means 5 × (–2) was taken as +10; 1 means $(-3)^2$ was taken as –9.	Negative numbers and powers
5	42	1	Usually 10% + 5% + 2.5% = 24 + 12 + 6.	Percentages of amounts
6	$2x - 15$	1	$-15 + 2x$. $2x - 5$ means only the first term was multiplied; $10x - 15$ means $4x$ was added.	Expanding a bracket and collecting like terms
7	33	1	–15 (9 – 24, a sign error in $-2ab$); 15 ($(-3)^2$ taken as –9).	Substitution with negative numbers
8	–3.5	1	–7/2, –3½, –14/4. 3.5 is a sign error; 6.5 or –6.5 means 6 was added to 20.	Solving a two-step equation with a negative answer
9	$26 - 3n$	1	$-3n + 26$. "Subtract 3" (the term-to-term rule) scores 0 but shows partial understanding: note it. $23 - 3n$ or $3n + 20$ score 0.	The nth term of a decreasing sequence

Section B: Word questions (8 marks)

Q	Answer	Marks	Accept, partial credit and common errors	Content
10	11	2	**M1** for $3(n + 6) = 51$, $(n + 6) \times 3 = 51$, or $51 \div 3 = 17$ seen. 33 (from $n + 6 \times 3 = 51$) means the order in the sentences was not followed; 15 (from $3n + 6 = 51$) the same.	"I think of a number": brackets from words
11	¥2 (2.00)	2	**M1** for $3(p + 2.50) + 2p = 17.50$, or $5p + 7.50 = 17.50$, or a trial checked correctly. 4.50 (the pen, not the pencil) scores 1. 3 (from $3p + 2.50 + 2p = 17.50$, with the 2.50 counted once) and 3.50 (17.50 ÷ 5) score 0.	Costs: forming and solving an equation with decimals
12	126 (cm^2)	2	**M1** for width 9 or length 14 (from $4w + 10 = 46$ or $2(w + w + 5) = 46$). 9 or 14 as the final answer scores 1. 132.25 (treated as a square, 11.5 × 11.5) scores 0.	Perimeter with algebraic sides, then area
13	15	2	**M1** for $3a + 5 = 2(a + 5)$, or Aisha's age 5 seen. 5 as the final answer (Aisha's age) scores 1. 30 (from $3a = 2(a + 5)$, forgetting that Amir also gets 5 years older) scores 0.	Ages: an equation with the unknown on both sides

Section C: Applied problems (12 marks)

Q	Answer	Marks	Accept, partial credit and common errors	Content
14	Carton **B** (1.2 litres)	2	**M1** for values that compare the two cartons by a correct method, for example ¥16.80 and ¥16.00 a litre; ¥1.68 and ¥1.60 for 100 ml; ¥2.52 and ¥2.40 for 150 ml; ¥50.40 and ¥48.00 for 3 litres; or ¥20.16 for 1.2 litres at Carton A's price. **A1** for correct values and B. "B" with no working, or "B because it is bigger", scores 0 (the question says Show).	Best buy: proportional reasoning with decimals and mixed units (ml and litres)
15	21 (points)	2	**M1** for 44 and 11 (the total and mean of games 1 to 4) with 13 seen, or 65 (5 × 13). 16 (60 – 44, using a mean of 12) and 13 (the new mean given as the score) score 0.	The mean with a missing value; reading a bar chart
16	x = 65, y = 115 (degrees)	3	**1** for x = 65. **1** for y = 115 (follow through: 180 – their x). **1** for a correct reason for x **and** a correct reason for y (both are needed for this mark): for x, vertically opposite angles are equal (angle AXB = 50°) or the base angles of an isosceles triangle are equal, or angles in a triangle add up to 180°; for y, angles on a straight line add up to 180°, or the exterior angle of a triangle equals the sum of the two opposite interior angles (50 + 65). Simple words are fine ("opposite angles are the same", "two equal sides so two equal angles", "a straight line is 180"). x = 50 (the given angle copied) scores 0.	Angle reasoning with reasons: vertically opposite angles, isosceles triangles, angles on a straight line
17	12:15	2	12:15 pm, 12.15, quarter past twelve. **M1** for 300 layers (60 ÷ 0.2), 9000 seconds, 150 minutes or 2 hours 30 minutes. 2 hours 30 minutes as the final answer scores 1. 10:00 (from 30 layers: 6 ÷ 0.2, with centimetres not changed to millimetres) scores 0.	Rates in an unfamiliar context; changing units (cm and mm, seconds, minutes and hours); time
18	a 26 · b 22 · c see the next column	1 + 1 + 1	a: 2 × 10 + 6, or counting on in twos from 8. b: 22 (22 grey tiles use 2 × 22 + 6 = 50 white tiles; 23 would need 52). 22.5 or 23 scores 0. c: any correct general reason: the number of white tiles is $2n + 6 = 2(n + 3)$, which is a multiple of 2; the white tiles are two equal rows (above and below) plus 2 at the ends; each new grey tile adds 2 white tiles, starting from 8. "8, 10 and 12 are even" (examples only) scores 0, because it does not explain why every pattern is even.	A linear pattern in context; the largest whole number that fits; explaining a general rule

Totals: Fluency (Section A) / 10 · Word questions (Section B) / 8 · Applied (Section C) / 12 · **Total / 30**.

Band guide v2 (maths, / 30; provisional, for a harder paper): 0 to 10 **1** Below expected (under 35%) · 11 to 16 **2** Working towards (35 to 54%) · 17 to 22 **3** Expected (55 to 74%) · 23 to 30 **4** Greater depth, likely top set (75% or more). List NT questions, and judge whether the student would reach band 3 once taught. These cut-offs are lower than in version 1 because the paper is harder; review them after the first 20 to 30 candidates.

Reading the three sub-scores

Profile	What it usually means	What to do
Fluency high (8 to 10), word questions low (0 to 4)	The English of the questions, not the maths, is the barrier.	Read the word questions aloud (and, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, once in Chinese, marked L). If the student then solves them, record on the grading sheet that the barrier is English.
Fluency and word questions high, applied low (under 6)	Strong calculation and setting up, less practice in multi-step problems, choosing a method and explaining.	The student needs teaching in problem solving and explaining, not more content. Note it in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet, for the maths teacher.
All three high (23 or more in total)	Greater depth.	Likely top set.
Fluency low, mostly on NT topics (1b, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9)	Gaps from the different order of topics in Chinese schools.	List the NT topics and judge whether the student will reach band 3 once taught.

Profile	What it usually means	What to do
Fluency low on familiar topics (1a, 2)	A real gap in calculation.	Note it in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet, with the word question and applied scores, for the maths teacher.

May not have been taught. A Year 7 entrant from a Chinese mainstream school has usually completed Grade 5 (PEP sequence; other textbooks differ a little, so ask the student). These topics are usually taught in Grade 6 or later, so the student **may not have been taught** them:

Questions	Topic	Usually taught in China
1b	Dividing fractions (adding fractions with different denominators and mixed numbers is Grade 5)	Grade 6
3	Powers such as 4^3 (squares may be familiar from area)	Grade 7
4, 7	Calculating with negative numbers	Grade 6 (meaning), Grade 7 (operations)
5	Percentages	Grade 6
6	Expanding brackets and collecting like terms	Grade 7
8	An equation with a negative answer (simple equations are Grade 5)	Grade 7
9, 18	A rule for the *n*th term (spotting patterns is common; letters for numbers is Grade 5)	Not taught formally
13	An equation with the unknown on both sides, such as $3a + 5 = 2(a + 5)$ (age problems are often solved without algebra in Chinese primary schools, and any correct method scores)	Grade 7
16	Vertically opposite angles (isosceles triangles, the angle sum of a triangle and angles on a straight line are Grade 4)	Grade 7

Usually **familiar**: decimals, including dividing by a decimal (Grade 5); adding and subtracting fractions (Grade 5); solving word problems with an equation (Grade 5, and often practised a lot in Chinese, so Section B mainly tests whether the student can read the problem in English); unit prices; the mean (Grade 4); perimeter and area (Grade 3); 24-hour time (Grade 3).

What to look for

- **Compare the three sub-scores** (table above) before deciding that a student is weak at maths.
- In Section B, a student who writes a correct equation but makes a slip has understood the English. A student who leaves the section blank, or combines the numbers in the order they appear (for example 6 × 3 + 51), has probably been stopped by the English: read the question aloud and see.
- Questions 14, 16 and 18c ask the student to show, give reasons or explain. Many students from Chinese schools give correct answers without reasons. A correct number with no reason gets the answer marks only. That is useful information for teachers, not a sign of weak maths.
- Strong students get 3, 8, 9, 13, 15, 17 and 18b, and give general reasons in 18c. Question 17 is an unfamiliar context: a student who changes 6 cm to 60 mm without being told is reading the problem carefully.

5. Science (8 minutes, 10 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Science pages. There are 6 questions. I can read any question to you. You have 8 minutes." The same access rules as maths apply (L and NT). Spelling does not matter in science answers if the word is recognisable (for example "ginko", "oxigen").

Q	Answer	Marks	Accept, partial credit and common errors	Content
1	A ginkgo · B maple · C lotus	2	**2** for all three; **1** for two. Uses a key (working scientifically).	Classification keys
2	oxygen	1	Carbon dioxide is a common confusion (it is given out in the lungs).	The heart and blood

Q	Answer	Marks	Accept, partial credit and common errors	Content
3	a 130 · b His muscles need more oxygen (or energy), so the heart pumps blood faster to carry it to them.	1 + 1	a: reading a graph between labelled gridlines. b: accept "his body needs more oxygen", "to get more energy to the muscles", "more blood goes to the muscles". Not: "because he is tired", "because running is hard".	Exercise and health; reading a graph
4	a bulb, switch, cell (left to right) · b **B**	1 + 1	a: all three for the mark. b: C (two bulbs) means the student thinks more bulbs give more light.	Circuit symbols; more cells and brighter bulbs
5	a the puppet she uses · b smaller	1 + 1	b: shorter, small, lower, less tall. "Bigger" means the table was read the wrong way.	Light and shadows; fair tests and variables; reading a table
6	The rocks were once under the sea.	1	The land or mountain was once the sea bed; the sea was there long ago; the rocks moved up from the sea. Not: "the animals climbed up", "a bird carried them".	Fossils and evolution

Band guide (science, / 10; provisional): 0 to 3 **1** · 4 to 5 **2** · 6 to 8 **3** · 9 to 10 **4**.

May not have been taught. Primary science (科学) in China covers these areas but the textbooks differ, so a Year 7 entrant **may not have been taught**: dichotomous keys (Q1; sorting living things is usually familiar), the heart and circulation in detail (Q2, Q3b; this comes fully in Grade 7 biology), circuit symbols (Q4a; circuits are Grade 4, often with drawings rather than symbols), and fossils and evolution (Q6). Light and shadows (Q5) are usually taught in Grade 5.

What to look for

- Questions 1, 3 and 5 test working scientifically (using a key, reading a graph and a table, fair tests). A student who does these well thinks scientifically even if the topic knowledge is NT.
- Short or one-word answers are fine. Answers must be in English; an explanation in Chinese scores 0.

6. Recording the results

1. **Mark the student paper.** Every question has a mark box.
2. **Copy the totals onto the grading sheet** (`Y07_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`) and give the bands from the band guides above (the grading sheet repeats them at a glance). Record there too the maths sub-scores and profile (Section 4), the NT topics and L questions, the writing task chosen, any access arrangements and your comment.
3. **Record the reading results and band on the Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`): the reading paper marks (Part A, Part B), the band and the question where the student stopped at 15 minutes.
4. **Give the interviewer the Reading front sheet and the Interview sheet** before the interview.
5. **After the interview, put together** the grading sheet, Reading front sheet, Interview sheet and parent conversation record, and complete the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`) within two working days. The overall English band is the band most of the four skills sit in: name any skill that is two or more bands below the others.
6. **File the marked student paper with them** (or shred it under the school's policy).

Interviewer guide: Years 7 to 10

This guide is reusable. Nothing is written on it: keep one in the room, in a folder or laminated. Ratings and notes for each student go on the **Interview sheet** (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y7_Y10`).

About 15 minutes, 1:1. The interview is held **in English**. It has three jobs: to hear the student's spoken English (the speaking band), to get to know the student (interests, learning, wellbeing, **future plans and aspirations**), and to judge their **suitability** for the international programme. It opens with the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (3 to 5 minutes; start Level 6 for Year 7, 7 for Year 8, 8 for Year 9, 9 for Year 10; follow `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide` and write the points on the Reading front sheet, `forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`).

How to ask. Start with the main question. If the student struggles, use the **easier** prompt (a yes or no, or a choice). If they answer easily, use the **stretch** prompt. This lets every student show their best English. Wait at least five seconds before rephrasing. Answers must be in English.

Pace of speech. Speak at a steady, clear pace, with a short pause after each sentence. Use the same pace for every candidate in the year group, and use it for the instructions and meaning questions of the sentence reading too. Do not rush: wait at least five seconds before rephrasing.

Safeguarding. Keep the door open or another adult present. If a student tells you something that worries you about their safety or wellbeing, do not promise to keep it secret; listen, write down their words, and pass it to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day.

1. Questions (10 minutes)

Choose about two questions from each block. On the Interview sheet, write short notes under "Key things the student said": what they said, and how they said it.

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch
Warm-up	Tell me a little about yourself.	What is your name? How old are you? Where do you live?	What would your friends say about you?
	How did you travel here today?	Did you come by car?	What do you like or dislike about your city?
School and learning	Tell me about your school now.	Do you like your school? What is your favourite subject?	What is the biggest difference you expect between your school and ours?
	Which subject do you find hardest? What do you do when work is difficult?	Is maths easy or hard for you?	Tell me about a time you kept going when something was hard.
	How do you learn English now?	Do you have English lessons? Do you read in English?	What helps you most when you learn new words?
	How do you feel about learning all your subjects in English?	Are you worried, excited, or both?	What will be hardest, and how will you deal with it?
Interests	What do you enjoy doing outside school?	Do you like sport, music or art?	What have you achieved in it that you are proud of?
	Tell me about a book, film or game you enjoyed.	Do you like reading? What kind of books?	Why did it stay in your mind?
	Do you take part in any clubs, competitions, volunteering or service?	Do you help at home or in your community?	What did you learn from it?
Friends and wellbeing	Who do you spend time with at school?	Do you have good friends?	How do you help a friend who is having a bad day?
	How do you relax when you feel tired or stressed?	What makes you happy?	How do you balance study, activities and rest?

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch
	How many classes or tutoring sessions do you have after school?	Do you have classes at the weekend?	How do you feel about how busy you are?
Future plans and aspirations	What would you like to do in the future?	Do you have a dream job?	What steps would get you there?
	Where would you like to study after school, and what would you study?	China or another country?	Why does that place or subject interest you?
	Why do you want to join the international programme? Whose idea was it?	Is it your idea or your parents' idea?	What do you hope it will give you that your school now does not?
	What kind of person do you want to be at our school?	Do you want to join clubs?	What could you give to our school community?
Values (choose one)	A classmate asks to copy your homework. What do you do?	Is it OK to copy homework?	Why does honesty matter in learning?
	A new student is sitting alone at lunch. What do you do?	Would you talk to them?	Why might someone find it hard to join a group?
Opinion (to hear extended speaking)	Should students have homework every day? Why, or why not?	Do you like homework?	What would be a better system? Give an example.
	Should phones be allowed in school?	Do you use a phone at school now?	What are the strongest arguments on the other side?
Year 10 only	Which IGCSE subjects would you like to take, and why?	Which subjects do you like best?	How do they connect to your future plans?
	The IGCSE course takes two years. How will you manage starting a new course in English?	Will it be hard for you?	What support will you look for, and from whom?
Questions for us	What would you like to ask me about the school?	Do you have any questions?	

2. Speaking band

Choose the band that fits best, using the evidence from the whole interview, and tick it on the Interview sheet. Rate **listening in conversation** (how much of your English they understood) with the same letters. Pronunciation features of a speaker of Chinese do not lower the band if the student is easy to understand.

Band	What you hear
A New to English	Little or no spoken English, or single memorised words and phrases ("I am fine"). Relies on Chinese, gesture or silence. Understands very little unless supported.
B Early acquisition	Short answers and simple memorised sentences on familiar topics (family, school, likes). Frequent errors in word order, verbs and plurals. Needs the easier prompts. Understands slow, simple questions.
C Developing competence	Answers most main questions with connected sentences, using "because", "but", "so". Errors are frequent but meaning is usually clear. Vocabulary is everyday; searches for words on less familiar topics. Can give a short opinion with a reason.
D Competent	Speaks at length on most questions, explains and gives examples, handles the stretch prompts with some effort. Errors are occasional and rarely affect meaning. Some subject and abstract vocabulary.
E Fluent	Speaks as fluently and accurately as a fluent English speaker of the same age. Handles abstract and hypothetical questions easily, with a wide vocabulary.

3. Suitability

Rate each strand on the Interview sheet from what you saw and heard: **1** Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong. Write the evidence: a short quotation or something you observed.

Strand	What strong looks like
Attitude to learning and resilience	Wants to learn, has a go, keeps going when work is hard, talks about effort and improvement
Curiosity and engagement	Asks questions, shows interest in ideas beyond the textbook, enjoys discussion
Social and emotional readiness	Relaxed or able to settle, makes eye contact (allowing for culture and shyness), talks about friends, manages feelings, ready for a change of school
Independence and self-management	Organises themselves, can describe how they study, manages time and activities, will ask for help
Values and conduct	Kind, honest and respectful in the interview and in the values question
Readiness for English-medium learning	Motivated to learn in English, willing to speak even with mistakes, has strategies for new words
Clarity and ownership of future plans	Has thought about what comes next, the plans are their own as well as the family's, understands why the international programme fits

Boarding readiness (only if the student will board): independence with daily routines, sleep, homesickness, experience of being away from home. Rate it on the Interview sheet in the same way.

4. Anything to follow up

Tick any that apply on the Interview sheet, and add a note:

- Possible special educational need or disability (for example reading, attention, speech, hearing, vision)
- Wellbeing (for example anxiety, low mood, very heavy workload, sleep)
- Safeguarding (passed to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day)
- Medical or dietary
- Mismatch between the student's wishes and the family's plans

Receiving homeroom teacher (optional). If the student's likely homeroom teacher meets them, they note first impressions and what the student would need in the first weeks (for example a buddy who speaks Chinese, a vocabulary book for each subject, a quiet check-in each morning) on the Interview sheet.

To finish. On the Interview sheet, write your comment for the final mark sheet (strengths, concerns, support), and sign and date it.

Graded Sentence Reading Screen: interviewer guide

What it is. A quick 1:1 read-aloud screen for every candidate from Year 1 to Year 10. The student reads sentences that get harder, from a reading age of about 5 to adult level, until they can no longer read them. It gives an **indicative reading age**, an accuracy profile, a **fluency** rating and an **understanding** check. It takes 2 to 6 minutes. In Years 1 to 3 it follows the Early Reading Screen; from Year 4 it opens the interview.

You need: the student card (`Sentence_Reading_Card`), this guide (the sentences are in Section 5), the **Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`), a pencil, and a plain card or sheet of paper to cover the sentences the student has not reached yet (this stops a page of text looking frightening). This guide is reusable: nothing is written on it. Write every point, meaning mark, total and result on the Reading front sheet.

1. Start, carry on, stop

Year applied for	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Start at level	1	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
First sentence	1	1	4	7	10	13	16	19	22	25

- If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1 whatever their age.
- **Going back (basal).** If the student scores 6 out of 6 on the start level, give full credit (6 points) for every level below it. If they score less than 6, go back one level at a time until they score 6 out of 6 on a level (or you reach Level 1). Then carry on upwards from the level after the start level.
- **Stopping (ceiling).** Always finish the start level. Then stop at the end of any level where the student scores **2 points or fewer**. Stop straight away if the student scores 0 on **three sentences in a row**, or if they become upset. Levels above the stopping point score 0.

Say: "I would like you to read some sentences out loud for me. They start easy and get harder. When they get too hard, that is fine, we will stop. If you do not know a word, have a go. Ready?" Point to the first sentence. You may say "Have a go" or "Try the next word". Do not sound out, explain or translate any word.

Pace of speech. When you give the instructions and ask the meaning questions, speak slowly and clearly, especially with the younger students. Use a short pause after each sentence, and a longer one with the younger students. Use the same pace for every candidate in a year group, and do not rush.

2. Scoring each sentence

Errors in the sentence	Points
none (self-corrections are fine)	**2**
one	**1**
two or more	**0**

These count as one error each

Code	Error	Example
S	**Substitution**: says a different word or a non-word	"horse" for house; "sur-pried" for surprised
O	**Omission**: leaves out a word, or leaves off a written ending that changes the word (-s, -ed, -ing, -ly)	"The frog jump out" for jumped
I	**Insertion**: adds a word that is not there	"the a red bus"
T	**Told**: no attempt after about 5 seconds; say the word, mark T	
	Two words read in the wrong order	one error

These are not errors (do not count them)

Code	What happens	Why it is not an error
SC	**Self-correction**: reads a word wrongly, then puts it right	The student is checking meaning.
R	**Repetition** of a word or phrase	
	Pauses, or sounding out and then blending the word correctly	Note it for fluency instead.
	Accent and pronunciation features common for speakers of Chinese, when the word is still clearly the right word: l and r ("lice" for rice), n and l, v and w, th as s, f, d or z ("sink" for think), a light or missing final consonant sound, an extra vowel after a final consonant ("bed-uh"), the -ed ending said in full ("jump-ed"), stress on a different syllable ("ho-TEL", "PHO-to-graph")	These are features of a learner's spoken English, not of reading. If the sound changes the word into a different word that makes sense, and you cannot tell which was meant, count it.
	Names (Ling, Jun, Mei) read in any reasonable way	
	Reading the British spelling as written ("tyres", "colour")	

When you are not sure, give the student the benefit of the doubt and write what they said on the Reading front sheet. Patterns (for example missing -ed endings throughout, or pinyin letter values such as "i" read as in pinyin) are useful evidence for the English profile.

3. Understanding (the meaning check)

After each level the student reads with **3 or more points**, ask the meaning question for that level (printed in Section 5), at the pace described in Section 1. Read the question aloud once and let the student answer in their own words. Mark ✓ (understood), **½** (partly) or ✗ (not understood) on the Reading front sheet. The answer must be in English: one word or a short phrase is enough, and pointing to the right words in the sentence also counts. An answer in Chinese is marked ✗.

4. Fluency

Rate the student's reading on the **last level they read with 4 or more points**, and write the rating on the Reading front sheet.

Rating	What it sounds like
1	Word by word. Long pauses. Little sense of the sentence as a whole.
2	Mostly two- or three-word groups, with some word-by-word reading. Little expression.
3	Mostly in sensible phrases. Some pauses to work out harder words. The sentence makes sense to the listener.
4	Smooth and phrased, close to natural speech, with stress and expression that show understanding.

5. Interviewer's copy of the sentences

The student reads from the card (`Sentence_Reading_Card`). Follow this copy as they read, and write the points (2, 1 or 0 for each sentence), the meaning mark and the level total on the **Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`).

No.	Sentence (Level 1)
1	I can see a red bus.
2	The cat sat on my bed.
3	Dad has a big hat.
	Meaning (sentence 2): "Where did the cat sit?" *Accept: On the bed, on my bed.*

No.	Sentence (Level 2)
4	We went to the shop to get some milk.
5	The frog jumped out of the pond.
6	They like to play in the park.
	Meaning (sentence 4): "What did they go to the shop to get?" *Accept: Milk.*

No.	Sentence (Level 3)
7	Ling put on her coat because it was cold outside.
8	The little boat floated slowly down the river.
9	Grandma made noodles for everyone at the party.
	Meaning (sentence 7): "Why did Ling put on her coat?" *Accept: Because it was cold (outside).*

No.	Sentence (Level 4)
10	After school, Jun and his friends played football on the green field.
11	The children could hear the water splashing against the rocks.
12	Most people carry an umbrella when the clouds turn grey.
	Meaning (sentence 11): "What could the children hear?" *Accept: Water splashing (on the rocks), the sea or river hitting the rocks.*

No.	Sentence (Level 5)
13	Mei was surprised to find a tiny kitten hiding behind the library door.
14	Before the long journey, Dad checked that the tyres had enough air.
15	The strange noise in the kitchen turned out to be a hungry mouse.
	Meaning (sentence 14): "What did Dad check before the journey?" *Accept: The tyres; that the tyres had enough air.*

No.	Sentence (Level 6)
16	Although the mountain path was difficult, the whole class reached the top before noon.
17	The museum guide explained how early people made tools from stone and bone.
18	My favourite season is autumn, when the leaves change colour and the air feels fresh.
	Meaning (sentence 18): "What happens to the leaves in autumn?" *Accept: They change colour (accept: they turn red, yellow or brown).*

No.	Sentence (Level 7)
19	The weather forecast warned that the temperature would drop sharply during the night.
20	Our neighbour immediately recognised the voice on the telephone and smiled.
21	The community worked together to clean the river and protect the local environment.
	Meaning (sentence 19): "What did the weather forecast say?" *Accept: It will get much colder at night; the temperature will go down a lot.*

No.	Sentence (Level 8)
22	The scientists collected evidence carefully before they announced the results of their experiment.
23	A queue of excited passengers waited patiently on the platform for the delayed train.
24	The ancient bridge, which was built from enormous stones, has survived for centuries.
	Meaning (sentence 23): "Why were the passengers waiting?" *Accept: Their train was late (delayed).*

No.	Sentence (Level 9)
25	The orchestra rehearsed for several weeks to perfect the rhythm of the challenging final movement.
26	Volunteers distributed warm blankets and hot drinks to the runners who had finished the marathon.
27	Although the explanation seemed reasonable, the detective suspected that the witness was not telling the truth.
	Meaning (sentence 27): "What did the detective think about the witness?" *Accept: The witness was lying, or not telling the whole truth.*

No.	Sentence (Level 10)
28	The architect's design was praised for combining traditional courtyards with sustainable, energy-saving technology.
29	Researchers are investigating whether the mysterious behaviour of the birds is caused by changes in climate.
30	The committee unanimously agreed that the proposal was too expensive and would require further consideration.
	Meaning (sentence 29): "What are the researchers trying to find out?" *Accept: Whether climate change is the reason the birds behave strangely.*

No.	Sentence (Level 11)
31	The psychologist's analysis suggested that the athlete's anxiety was caused by an unconscious fear of failure.
32	Meticulous archaeologists spent months excavating the tomb, revealing exquisite pottery and bronze ornaments.
33	The government's ambitious infrastructure programme has transformed transport links between rural and urban regions.
	Meaning (sentence 32): "What did the archaeologists find?" *Accept: Beautiful (very fine) pottery and bronze ornaments, in a tomb.*

No.	Sentence (Level 12)
34	The connoisseur's idiosyncratic taste baffled the gallery owner, who had anticipated a more conventional choice.
35	Despite the ostensibly benign forecast, the meteorologist remained sceptical and recommended a thorough reassessment.
36	The philosopher's paradoxical aphorisms were considered unfathomable by most of her contemporaries.
	Meaning (sentence 35): "How did the meteorologist feel about the forecast?" *Accept: Did not believe it, doubted it, wanted it checked again.*

6. Reading age

Total points = points scored + 6 for every level below the basal level that was not read.

Reading age (years:months) = 5:00 + 2 months for every point (0 points: below 5:00). So 6 points = 6:00 (Level 1 secure), 12 points = 7:00, 30 points = 10:00, 60 points = 15:00, 72 points = 17:00 (the ceiling: report "16 years or above" for 66 points or more).

Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age
1	5:02	13	7:02	25	9:02	37	11:02	49	13:02	61	15:02
2	5:04	14	7:04	26	9:04	38	11:04	50	13:04	62	15:04
3	5:06	15	7:06	27	9:06	39	11:06	51	13:06	63	15:06
4	5:08	16	7:08	28	9:08	40	11:08	52	13:08	64	15:08
5	5:10	17	7:10	29	9:10	41	11:10	53	13:10	65	15:10
6	6:00	18	8:00	30	10:00	42	12:00	54	14:00	66	16:00
7	6:02	19	8:02	31	10:02	43	12:02	55	14:02	67	16:02
8	6:04	20	8:04	32	10:04	44	12:04	56	14:04	68	16:04
9	6:06	21	8:06	33	10:06	45	12:06	57	14:06	69	16:06
10	6:08	22	8:08	34	10:08	46	12:08	58	14:08	70	16:08
11	6:10	23	8:10	35	10:10	47	12:10	59	14:10	71	16:10
12	7:00	24	9:00	36	11:00	48	13:00	60	15:00	72	17:00

Write on the Reading front sheet: total points, reading age, actual age (years:months), the difference (reading age minus actual age), meaning checks (levels asked, how many ✓) and fluency rating (1 to 4).

7. What the result means

This screen is not standardised. The reading ages come from the way the sentences were built (how common the words are, the spelling patterns in the English National Curriculum word lists for each year, and the length and structure of the sentences). Treat a reading age as a range of about 6 months either side. Once 30 to 50 students have taken it, compare their reading ages with the reading paper and with how they get on in class, and adjust the guide below if needed.

The reading band. In Years 1 to 3 the reading band comes from the Early Reading Screen; in Years 4 to 10 from the reading paper. This screen confirms the band. Use the table as a guide; if this screen and the main reading result differ by more than one band, look for the reason (below).

Reading age compared with actual age	Years 3 to 5	Years 6 to 10
At or above actual age, or close below it	up to 6 months below: **E**	up to 12 months below: **E**
Below	7 to 12 months below: **D**	13 to 24 months below: **D**
Well below	13 to 24 months below: **C**	25 to 42 months below: **C**
Far below	25 to 36 months below: **B**	43 to 60 months below: **B**
Very far below, or Level 1 not secure	more than 36 months below: **A**	more than 60 months below: **A**

- **Years 1 and 2.** Many fluent English speakers score 0 to 6 points at the start of Year 1. At the start of Year 2 a fluent reader usually has Level 1 secure and often Level 2. Use the reading age as supporting evidence only.
- **Decoding ahead of understanding.** If the meaning checks on the last two levels read are mostly ✗, move the band down one. This is common for students who learnt phonics or the phonetic alphabet well but have a small English vocabulary: they can "say" words they do not know.
- **Understanding ahead of decoding.** A student who understands well (✓ throughout) but stops early on long, rare words may be a confident English user who has had little reading practice, or may have a specific difficulty with reading. Look at the Early Reading Screen or the reading paper and, if there is a pattern, raise it in the summary.
- **Low fluency** (rating 1 or 2) with a good reading age often means effortful decoding: the student will find long texts in English tiring at first.
- **Level 1 not secure** at any age: use the letter sounds and Section 1 words of the Early Reading Screen to find what the student knows.

Write on the Reading front sheet: the indicative band, and one line on patterns noticed.